

Event Information:

EventID :
118
Event Time :
Feb, 28, 2022, 04:12 AM
Rule :
SOC168 - Whoami Command Detected in Request Body
Level :
Security Analyst
Hostname :
WebServer1004
Destination IP Address :
172.16.17.16
Source IP Address :
61.177.172.87
HTTP Request Method :
POST
Requested URL :
https://172.16.17.16/video/
User-Agent :
Mozilla/4.0 (compatible; MSIE 6.0; Windows NT 5.1; SV1)
Alert Trigger Reason :
Request Body Contains whoami string
Device Action :
Allowed

Analysis Steps:

Logs were searched with attacker IP 61[.]177.172.87 as the source and WebServer1004 IP 172[.]16.17.16 as the destination in the relevant time-frame yielding 5 events. The attacker can be seen attempting command injection on the /video/ endpoint utilising Linux commands such as ?c=whoami as POST parameters. These logs also appear to be dated at a time which would be out of normal administrator operation hours, however, this is not conclusive.

Alert details evidence successful execution of this and other related command injection attempts via a HTTP 200 (OK) status combined with the varying response sizes.

✓ 5 events (before Feb, 28, 2022, 04:15 AM UTC)		
< Hide Fields INTERESTING FIELDS α type α source_address # source_port α destination_address # destination_port α raw_log	Event	
	destination_port	443
	time	Feb, 28, 2022, 04:12 AM
	Raw Log	
	Request URL	https://172.16.17.16/video/
	User-Agent	Mozilla/4.0 (compatible; MSIE 6.0; Windows NT 5.1; SV1)
	Request Method	POST
	Device Action	Permitted
	HTTP Response Size:	912
	HTTP Response Status	200
	POST Parameters	?c=whoami

The threat actor can be seen to then use this vulnerability to collect sensitive information from the Web Server via injection of the [cat /etc/passwd] command.

destination_address	172.16.17.16
destination_port	443
time	Feb, 28, 2022, 04:14 AM
Raw Log	
Request URL	https://172.16.17.16/video/
User-Agent	Mozilla/4.0 (compatible; MSIE 6.0; Windows NT 5.1; SV1)
Request Method	POST
Device Action	Permitted
HTTP Response Size:	1321
HTTP Response Status	200
POST Parameters	?c=cat /etc/passwd

WebServer1004's terminal history was then analysed for the appropriate time frame to find that the commands were successfully executed.

 EVENT TIME	COMMAND LINE
08.02.2022 16:21	docker-compose -f docker-compose-deploy.yml build
08.02.2022 16:36	docker-compose -f docker-compose-deploy.yml up
28.02.2022 04:11	ls
28.02.2022 04:12	whoami
28.02.2022 04:13	uname
28.02.2022 04:14	cat /etc/passwd
28.02.2022 04:17	cat /etc/shadow

The gathered information was enough to warrant device containment to limit further organisational damage and consider this alert to be a successful True Positive.

The offending IP is not in our database and is external to the organisation. No emails have been received indicating penetration testing involving the IP for the relevant time period. VirusTotal indicates it is a Chinese address associated with 61.[.]177.172.87 AS 4134 (Chinanet). 3/91 security vendors flagged this IP address as malicious.

3

/ 91

Community Score

-1

3/91 security vendors flagged this IP address as malicious

Reanalyze More

61.177.172.87 (61.177.128.0/17)

AS 4134 (Chinanet)

CN

Last Analysis Date

3 days ago

DETECTION

DETAILS

RELATIONS

COMMUNITY 62

Join our Community and enjoy additional community insights and crowdsourced detections, plus an API key to automate checks.

Security vendors' analysis ⓘ

Do you want to automate checks?

ADMINUSLabs	Malicious	Chong Lua Dao	Malicious
Fortinet	Malware	alphaMountain.ai	Suspicious
AlphaSOC	Suspicious	Abusix	Clean

On AbuseIPDB this IP was reported 86,681 times with a 0% confidence of abuse.

61.177.172.87 was found in our database!

This IP was reported 86,681 times. Confidence of Abuse is 0%: ?

0%

ISP

CHINANET jiangsu province network

Usage Type

Fixed Line ISP

ASN

[AS4134](#)

Domain Name

chinatelecom.cn

Country

China

City

Nanjing, Jiangsu

IP info including ISP, Usage Type, and Location provided by [IPInfo](#). Updated weekly.

REPORT 61.177.172.87

WHOIS 61.177.172.87

Based on following Playbook procedure and the analysis of available information, this alert is determined to be a successful true positive.

Report:

Incident Summary

Analysis confirms a True Positive command injection attack against WebServer1004. An external threat actor successfully extracted confidential server information via the /video/ endpoint. The host has been contained and the ticket is escalated to Tier 2 for further review.

Incident Details

- **Alert Name:** SOC168 - Whoami Command Detected in Request Body
- **Attacker IP:** 61[.]177.172.87 AS 4134 (Chinanet)
- **Target Host:** WebServer1004 (172[.]16.17.16)
- **Attack Vector:** HTTP POST requests

Analysis and Evidence

- **Attack Execution:** The attacker used POST Parameters to conduct command injection [hxxps://172[.]16.17.16/video/].
- **Success Confirmation:** The server responded with HTTP Status 200 (Permitted) for all requests. HTTP Response Sizes varied. The commands can also be observed as having been run on WebServer1004 via its terminal history.

Threat Intelligence

- **OSINT:** The IP is not in our database. VirusTotal lists 3/91 security vendors flagged this IP address as malicious. AbuseIPDB lists this IP was reported 86,681 times with a 0% confidence of abuse.
- **Internal Correlation:** A review of internal communications confirmed no authorised penetration testing scheduled involving any devices related to this alert in the relevant time-frame.

Actions Taken

1. Contained WebServer1004 to prevent further data exfiltration.
2. Declared True Positive.
3. Escalated to Tier 2 for impact assessment and remediation.

Let's Defend Result

SOC168 - Whoami Command Detected in Request Body

True Positive (+5 Point)

Do You Need Tier 2 Escalation? (+5 Point)

Was the Attack Successful? (+5 Point)

What Is the Direction of Traffic? (+5 Point)

Check If It Is a Planned Test (+5 Point)

What Is The Attack Type? (+5 Point)

Is Traffic Malicious? (+5 Point)